SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #20 · FAMILY MONEY MESSAGES

“Wealthy people can't be trusted.”

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Where it often comes from

Many of us learned this from a boss who underpaid us, a landlord who ignored repairs, a family who felt looked down on, or a community that felt used. Stories and media can add to it. Real unfairness exists, so the belief grows from something true. But when it becomes a rule about every wealthy person, it can block friendships, jobs, mentors, and even our own ability to prosper without guilt.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture warns about the dangers of riches and the injustice of those who oppress the poor. It also tells us that the rich and the poor have this in common: the Lord is Maker of them all. Job was blameless and upright and was also very wealthy. Zacchaeus, a rich man, gave half his possessions to the poor and was welcomed by Jesus. James says not to show favoritism, and Paul tells the rich to be generous and ready to share. Trust is measured by character, not by bank balance.

> *“The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all”* (Proverbs 22:2).

Also see

> “There was a man in the land of Uz whose name was Job. And this man was blameless and upright, fearing God and shunning evil” (Job 1:1).

> “But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, ‘Look, Lord, half of my possessions I give to the poor, and if I have cheated anyone, I will repay it fourfold.’” (Luke 19:8).

> “Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share” (1 Timothy 6:18).

> “My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism” (James 2:1).

Common self-statements

- Rich people got there by cheating.
- They look down on people like me.
- They will always put money first.
- I cannot be friends with someone who has that much.
- If I become wealthy, I will become like them.
- Wealth corrupts everyone.

Common logical errors

- Stereotyping: Treating every wealthy person as the same.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning a few hurtful experiences into a rule.
- Mind reading: Assuming that I know what a wealthy person thinks of me.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that people are either poor and good or rich and bad.

Challenging questions

- Whom did I learn this from, and what actually happened?

- Do I know any wealthy people who are honest and kind? What do I know about them?
- Do I know any poor people who have been unfair or unkind? What does that show?
- What does Scripture say about how to judge a person?
- How does this belief affect my opportunities or my own view of success?
- What would it look like to treat people as individuals?

Truth summary

> Some wealthy people have wronged others, and so have some poor people. Wealth does not decide whether a person is trustworthy. God made us all, and He looks at character and the heart. I can be wise, set boundaries where needed, and still treat each person as an individual.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prejudice
- Judgmental
- Riches, Beware of
- Trust
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Judgmental
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Our God — Chris Tomlin
God's greatness challenges helplessness before evil or hardship.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Wealthy people can't be trusted"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Wealthy people can't be trusted." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ What actually happened?
- ☐ Who does not fit this belief?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about judging people?
- ☐ How does this belief affect me?
- ☐ How can I judge people one at a time?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The rich and the poor are both made by God.
- ☐ Character matters more than a bank balance.
- ☐ I can be wise without stereotyping.
- ☐ Real injustice deserves real concern.
- ☐ I can prosper and stay generous.
- ☐ I can judge people one at a time.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Proverbs 22:2
  "The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all."
- ☐ Luke 19:8
  "But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, 'Look, Lord, half of my possessions I give to the poor, and if I have cheated anyone, I will repay it fourfold.'"
- ☐ James 2:1
  "My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Individuals, not categories: Each week, note one person who did not fit a stereotype you held, and what you saw.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 22:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God made the rich and the poor, so I can look at character, not just a bank balance.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] List the experiences. Write down what happened to you or your family and what you learned.
- [ ] Find a counter-example. Learn about a wealthy person known for integrity and generosity.
- [ ] Practice individual judgment. Next time you meet someone, notice their actions before you assign a category.
- [ ] Define your own wealth. Write what generous, trustworthy success would look like for you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Wealthy people can't be trusted": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A person, not a category
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Wealthy people can't be trusted.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You are Maker of the rich and the poor. Heal what has been done to me and my family, and keep me from judging others by their bank balance. Give me wisdom to see character and a heart that stays generous. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.